Wayne Williams Opanja

Product Manager · AI, fintech and public-sector products

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PROFILE

Product manager with an engineer's background, delivering software since 2023, most at home where products, payments and partner teams meet. Leads PropFlow at Pneuma Labs, an AI and automated property-management system with online payments, built security-first: every action logged, AI output checked against strict rules before anything happens, nightly backups and a written recovery plan. Took it to partner companies in Uganda and Rwanda and trained five CEOs and their CTOs to run it. Previously Senior Software Engineer at ProDG Studios: eleven months on CrossVest, an investment platform that partner apps embed, from identity checks and payments built around regulatory and FX constraints to the API specification, QA and UAT into production, with security planned in advance because it held customer funds. CHFI-certified, with penetration testing for a financial cooperative. Works with Jira, Slack, REST APIs, Next.js, PostgreSQL and Paystack.

EXPERIENCE

Product Manager · Pneuma Labs | Nairobi, clients in 6 countries | 2026 – Present

AI and automation company: 8 projects for 8 clients in logistics, real estate, mining, financial services and government across the UK, Kenya, Uganda, Rwanda, Burundi and the DRC.

- **PropFlow, AI and automated property management (product lead):** led the product with a partner: rent, invoicing, arrears, tenant receipts, leases signed online and maintenance with contractor approvals run automatically, with Paystack payments, and landlords get reports, including on WhatsApp. Built for trust: secure sign-in, a full audit log of every action, AI output checked against a strict schema before any action, error monitoring, nightly backups and a written recovery plan. Live with users in Kenya, Uganda and Rwanda.
- **Partner onboarding for PropFlow:** travelled to Uganda and Rwanda to meet partner companies, including the leadership teams of Keystone Technologies and Unispace, and trained five CEOs, property owners and their CTOs in Rwanda to run it.
- **Client delivery:** run projects from the first discovery call to production: scoping, user research, prototypes, build, QA, user acceptance testing, handover and support, for 8 clients in six countries.
- **Nairobi City County revenue assistant:** scoped and delivered a tool that turned the county's revenue reports into one clean database, with an AI assistant staff can question on WhatsApp or the web. Access is least-privilege: the AI can only run validated read-only queries, and its answers were checked against the original reports before staff relied on it.
- **Stock research assistant:** AI agents that research Nairobi Securities Exchange stocks every morning, argue the case for and against, check risk against inflation and log each call so accuracy can be measured. Used by analysts, then sold to another business, where it still runs.
- **Process automation and enablement:** mapped how the teams at Mediscope and the Strathmore Centre for Value Investing work, designed automations around it, and trained the Centre's team to use them.

Senior Software Engineer · ProDG Studios | UK, full-time, remote | 2025 – 2026

- **Cross-border investment platform (CrossVest, Venture Garden Group):** main frontend engineer for eleven months on a marketplace that partner apps embed, connecting investors in the US and Europe with African markets. Integrated it with IMTOs (international money transfer operators), so their customers could invest from apps they already use. Worked on the partner, fund-manager and admin portals, backend APIs and the cash-out flow, with identity checks through Smile ID and Sumsub and payments built around regulatory and FX constraints. Took it through QA and UAT into production.
- **CrossVest research and QA:** wrote the roadmap audit, the workflow explainer and the frontend-to-backend API specification; reviewed teammates' pull requests and ran end-to-end QA ahead of UAT.
- **CrossVest security:** planned security in advance because the platform held customer funds: an incident playbook, exact money handling, logs stripped of personal data and strict roles.

- **RICC security and QA:** led about 30 bug-fix pull requests before handover of Nigeria's national innovation portal, including security fixes (path traversal, spreadsheet formula injection, personal data in audit logs), and wrote a 142-case test pack across 20 modules.
- **RICC national innovation portal, Federal Ministry of Education, Nigeria:** researched why universities, industry, investors and regulators weren't connecting, then turned that into questionnaires and user journeys for each stakeholder group and a portal that replaced a Google Forms process. Led its frontend development and UI/UX, including offline data collection for field agents. It went into a national rollout (ricc.education.gov.ng).
- **NGAO, field data collection without paper:** full-stack developer on a platform that replaced paper forms for last-mile reporting with a WhatsApp conversation people already know how to use. It grew past 3,000 users after rollout.

CLIENT AND PARTNER ENGAGEMENTS

Technical Analyst and Partner · Climate Shapers Africa | Nairobi

Joined as a data scientist; promoted to technical analyst; now a partner.

- **Working with banks:** built climate-stress exposure analytics for the Kenya Bankers Association (covering Kenya and Tanzania), linking climate indicators to the chance of loan default, with NCBA, Equity Bank and Victoria Commercial Bank among the stakeholders.

Penetration Testing Consultant · Harambee SACCO

- Tested a financial cooperative's systems and set out the fixes.

SELECTED PROJECTS

- **Harambee Shop:** group buying at wholesale prices with M-Pesa. Shared baskets, a pricing engine that shares the saving with customers, verified payments, refunds and M-Pesa cash-outs, and a live pilot with real payments. Heavily tested. *Free Pascal (mORMot2), Next.js, PostgreSQL, Redis, Paystack.*
- **MessageHeard (full-stack developer, 2025 – 2026):** delivered an AI video platform for a US and UK client on an 8.5-week plan, with weekly client stand-ups and internal dev stand-ups.
- **Chat Your Finances (lead developer):** AI assistant that reads M-Pesa, bank and payslip statements and answers money questions on WhatsApp, Telegram and web, with a guide to filing with KRA.
- **Breach Alert (sole engineer):** data-breach monitoring where people prove they own what they monitor; emails encrypted at rest, passwords checked by partial hash so they never leave the device, and an admin review desk for uncertain matches.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

- **Strathmore University:** Bachelor of Business Information Technology (2024 – 2027, in progress, Grade A average); Diploma in Business Information Technology (2023 – 2024). Coursework includes an event-streaming pipeline with Apache Kafka, Docker and PostgreSQL.
- **Strathmore Institute of Mathematical Sciences, Student Assistant (Developer) (2023 – 2025):** built a course evaluation system (Django, React, PostgreSQL) that increased student feedback rates and gave staff timely analytics.
- **Strathmore University ICT, Software Developer Intern (2025 – 2026, degree internship):** rebuilt the phone-billing system as an Odoo module with call-record and HR/ERP sync.
- **Certifications:** CHFI, EC-Council (2024); Google Cybersecurity; Simplilearn Full-Stack Development.
- **Languages:** English and Swahili (fluent), German (beginner).